Aki Fukai

Freelance Product Designer

0→1 B2B SaaS/Enterprise

Hamburg · Berlin · Zurich
Remote: US East Coast compatible
Swiss Citizen

+49 172 431 15 00
aki@fukai.ch
www.fukai.ch
in/fukai

Engagement Model

Freelance Product Designer
B2B Retainer Contracts (3–18 months)

Toolkit

Design-to-Code Bridge: Figma (Variables & Tokens) · Figma MCP server · Markdown Claude · Component driven design · VS Code · Git workflows · Modern HTML/CSS Meaningful CSS Transitions

Collaborative Ideation: Notion · tldraw/ Miro/FigmJam · Slack · JIRA/Asana/ Linear · Google Workspace · Relume · Various (AI) prototyping tools

Methodologies: Shape Up · Hypothesis-driven validation · JTBD · Service Design · Lean UX · Various mapping techniques

Workflow Effectiveness: Cross-functional alignment eliminating translation gaps · Regulatory constraint adaptation

Languages

German: Mother tongue
English: Full professional proficiency
French: Intermediate level (B1)
Japanese & Zulu: Beginner level

Education

HAW Hamburg, Department Design Communication design (with an internship at Fork Unstable Media)

Principal Product Designer with >20 years of experience and 12+ years designing scalable software in FinTech, HR Tech, Team collaboration, and Sustainability. Expert in transforming complex requirements and regulations into intuitive mobile/web/POS platforms and products through collaborative, hypothesis-driven design.

Expertise: 0→1 platform design leadership · Rapid MVP validation · Regulatory UX · Design systems · Cross-functional alignment

Impact: Multiple successful SaaS launches · Best startup award · Rapid concept-to-market cycles · Enterprise pilot validation

Recent Engagements Overview (by relevance)

Founding Interaction Designer, collectAI (Otto Group) · FinTech / Payments / Mobile, Web / AI
Senior Product Designer, enfore AG · ERP System / POS SaaS / Mobile, Web, POS
Principal Product Designer, PlasticPlan (Henkel) · AI-Powered B2B SaaS / Circular Economy
Principal Product Designer, WHATEVER.WORKS (JobRad) · HR Tech / B2B SaaS Corporate Venture
Senior Interaction Designer, frog for Siemens/Unify · Cloud-Based Enterprise Communications SaaS
Co-Founder & Principal Designer, Hello Meet · Social Scheduling SaaS Product / C2B

Principal Product Designer, SDGventure

Jul 2024 – Present · Part-time advisory role · Remote
Impact-focused venture building collective.

Hands-on strategic design leadership with Product and Tech Leads for corporate innovation projects. Operating as venture building, SaaS and multi platform expert within Europe's leading sustainable venture ecosystem, collaborating on corporate ventures and spin-offs.

Reference: *Patrick Koegel, Founder & CPO @ SDGventure*

Principal Product Designer, whatever.works (JobRad Venture)

May 2023 – Jun 2024 · 1 year 2 months · Contract · Remote
HR Tech B2B SaaS platform (corporate venture)

Hands-on product design leadership from validation to MVP launch in close partnership with Interim CPO and Tech Lead.

Impact & End-to-End Design Leadership:

- **70-day MVP:** From early idea validation to MVP launch in 70 days
- **Product-Market Fit:** UX architecture and UI design system enabled scaling to 30+ B2B clients
- **Compliant UX Architecture:** Streamlined user flows for 150+ countries
- **Technical Integration:** Localisation (Lokalise), RBAC, SSO, account customisations, HRIS API integr.
- **Design System:** Scalable architecture enabled rapid feature development and client customisation
- **Process:** Adapted Shape Up framework to accelerate compliance-intensive product cycles
- **Team Building:** Hired, onboarded design talent within 1 week; mentored toward higher ownership
- **Alignment:** Engaged stakeholders across functions ensuring product and UX strategy buy-in
- **Award Recognition:** Contributed to "Best HR Startup 2023" award

Reference: *Uwe Michaelis, Founder & Managing Director @ WHATEVER.WORKS*

Principal Product Designer, PlasticPlan (Henkel Venture)

Feb – Jul 2022 · 6 months · Contract · Remote
AI-powered sustainability compliance SaaS for circular economy

Designed scalable enterprise system architecture for high-volume AI-driven data processing and multi-role workflows.

Enterprise Impact & Validation:

- **Cost Efficiency:** UX/UI design enabled up to 80% AI-driven reduction in plastic tax reporting costs
- **Data Scale:** 236M+ data points processed, 800K+ packaging comp., 160K+ products classified
- **AI-UX Integration:** Turned AI data checks into actionable UI with low cognitive and interaction cost
- **UX Coherence:** Coherent UX/UI in German and English incl. microcopy
- **Design System:** Scalable component driven UI systems for operational efficiency
- Role-based dashboards & reporting architecture

Reference: *Dr. Nora Mundschenk, Corporate Director Global Tax @ Henkel*

Aki Fukai

Freelance Product Designer

0→1 B2B SaaS/Enterprise

Hamburg · Berlin · Zurich
Remote: US East Coast compatible
Swiss Citizen

+49 172 431 15 00
aki@fukai.ch
www.fukai.ch
in/fukai

Senior Product Designer, enfore AG

Jun 2018 – May 2020 · 1 year 11 months · Hamburg (Hybrid)
Initially Freelance (B2B), later permanent role
ERP and POS SaaS platform for retail, hospitality, beauty and service.

Led UX architecture and design for retail and hospitality POS/ERP ecosystem serving SMEs. Delivered comprehensive modules including reservations, pick-up & delivery, online presence, business documents, a modular KPI dashboard and dashboard widgets.

Key Contributions:

- Integrated On/Offline Commerce: End-to-end online presence architecture (mobile, web and POS)
- SME-Focused UX: Simplified complex ERP processes for non-technical business users
- UX Architecture: Developed robust service blueprints to support fragmented, real-life user journeys with rapid context shifts and multi-role handovers
- Modular Design Systems: Scaled architecture for complex multi-device workflows across multiple verticals (gastronomy, retail, beauty salons, services, e-commerce)
- Engineering Partnership: Ensured design QA and performance throughout development cycles

Reference: *Christophe Stoll, Head of Design @ Enfore via small is beautiful*

Co-Founder & Principal Designer, Hello Meet — Group Scheduling

Jan 2018 – Mar 2024 · 6 years 3 months · Hamburg/Remote
Initially part-time, full-time Jun 2020 – Dec 2021
Group scheduling product (mobile app) and social network platform.

Co-founded an uncompromisingly user-centric scheduling platform challenging traditional group scheduling models and ad-tech driven Social Networks. Led complete product design from early concepts and business model design through multiple product iterations.

Strategic Contributions:

- Product Architecture: JTBD-based UX strategy with hypothesis-driven validation cycles
- Cross-Platform Systems: Designed and maintained design systems across iOS, Android, Web
- Product Development: Led end-to-end feature delivery using our assumption mapping method and drove continuous improvements through user-centered insights
- Innovation Model: Pioneered C2B approach disrupting traditional enterprise scheduling workflows

---

Founding Interaction Designer, collectAI (Liquid Labs, Otto Group)

Feb 2016 – Feb 2018 · 1 year 11 months · Hamburg (on-site)
Initially Freelance (B2B), later permanent role
FinTech B2B2C receivables automation SaaS

Led the UX and design as the founding product designer to create a customer centric collections platform. Designed scalable dunning and self-service payment flows for enterprise clients within regulated finance environment. Architected a B2B2C SaaS receivables management platform, powered by smart ML driven claim resolution.

Specialized Contributions:

- Traction: Crafted the product design that scaled receivables management to €25M in 18 months
- White-Label Architecture: Built modular UX systems supporting multiple client brands
- Payment Journey Optimization: Self-service flows reducing customer service dependencies
- Regulatory Compliance: Receivables management workflows within strict financial and GDPR rules

Reference: *Michael Backes, Co-Founder & CTO @ collectAI*

Lead Interaction Designer, SBB Swiss Federal Railways (IVEG)

Nov 2015 – Sep 2016 · 11-month contract · Bern, Switzerland (on-site > hybrid)
Enterprise GIS / Infrastructure SaaS

Digitised field-service-to-back-office workflows for vegetation risk assessment (iPad/web).

Technical Integration:

- Service Design Workshops: Complete workflow mapping from field assessment to procurement
- Component Library: UI systems aligned with SBB corporate identity across iOS and web
- Stakeholder Complexity: Public sector hierarchy alignment through iterative design workshops

Reference: *Simon Haesler, Product Owner & GIS Specialist @ SBB CFF FFS*

Aki Fukai

Freelance Product Designer

0→1 B2B SaaS/Enterprise

Hamburg · Berlin · Zurich
Remote: US East Coast compatible
Swiss Citizen

+49 172 431 15 00
aki@fukai.ch
www.fukai.ch
in/fukai

Senior Interaction Designer, frog for Siemens/Unify

Sep 2013 – Jan 2014 · 5-month contract · Munich (on-site)
Enterprise Communications / Cloud-Based Team Collaboration SaaS

Designed the real-time collaboration experience design for “Project Ansible” (productized as Circuit) with frog Munich in close collaboration with the product leads and lead software architects from Unify. Seamless cross-platform consistency across mobile, web, and tablet for multi-modal enterprise communication requirements.

Reference: *Justin Maguire III, Executive Creative Director @ frog Munich*

Further Freelance Engagements

PropTech Startup Startup Brand Identity · 2025
Time Management B2B SaaS Rebranding & Relaunch · 2025
Babymarkt UX Audit · 2022
Tagesspiegel Media Relaunch · 2022
Mercedes-Benz Design System Refactoring · 2022-2023
1komma5° Design System Consulting · 2024
SAP (Fiori) Design System & UX Consulting · 2015
Telefónica o2 Relaunch o2online.de · 2011
CTS Eventim Relaunch eventim.de · 2008
Daimler/Mercedes-Benz Relaunch My Mercedes · 2009
Rossmann Relaunch online shop, corporate site, career portal · 2008-2012